

CORE PROTOCOL

QUICKPLAY COMPANION

The table-side version of *The Ultron Directive*. Full campaign book for story; this guide for play.

CURRENT CAMPAIGN STATE

Issue ____ • Intel ____ • Network ____ • Hero/Aspect _____ • Field Asset(s) _____

Before Every Issue

1	Use the required hero, villain, modular set, and tier. Pick an aspect that hero has not used earlier in the main story.
2	Apply issue pre-setup/set-aside instructions, then complete normal scenario setup.
3	Resolve campaign setup, continuity flags, Interlude choice, Network setup effects, and Final Preparation if Issue 15.
4	Choose Field Assets: normally 1; if Network 6+, choose 2. At 15+ Intel, Endgame Protocol does not count against the limit in Issue 15.
5	Draw and mulligan. If Network 6+, then deal yourself the Prepared Ambush facedown encounter card.

After the Game

RECORD IT NOW

Win: +1 Intel. Objective: +1 Intel. First-time Hero Mastery: +1 Intel. Hero defeat: +1 Network and 1 Scar. Main-scheme loss: +2 Network. Objectives and Mastery remain recorded even if you later lose. A Scar lowers only the starting hit-point dial by 1; it does not lower maximum HP. Remove 1 Scar when that hero wins.

Recommended First-Run Aspect Route

Hero	1st	2nd	3rd	First Mirror
Spider-Man	Protection	Justice	Leadership	Aggression
Captain Marvel	Leadership	Aggression	Justice	Protection
She-Hulk	Aggression	Leadership	Justice	Protection
Iron Man	Justice	Aggression	Leadership	Protection
Black Panther	Justice	Aggression	Protection	Leadership

SIGNAL FRACTURE

STANDARD • villain I → II • Standard encounter set

ISSUE 01		THE BREAK-IN		
Spider-Man / Spiderman		Rhino / Rino	Bomb Scare / Amenaza de bomba	STANDARD
SETUP Set Bomb Scare aside before shuffling; reveal it after normal setup. Apply active Network Adaptations.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Bomb Scare before Rhino advances to stage II.	Flag: BOMB DEFUSED
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 02		SOUND MONEY		
Captain Marvel / Capitana Marvel		Klaw	Masters of Evil / Señores del Mal	STANDARD
SETUP Set The Masters of Evil side scheme aside; reveal it after normal setup. Resolve its printed When Revealed ability normally; that Master is the objective target.			OBJECTIVE Defeat the side scheme and that Master before Klaw.	Flag: MASTERS BROKEN
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 03		MACHINE IN THE STATIC		
She-Hulk / Hulka		Ultron / Ultrón	Under Attack / Civiles en peligro	STANDARD
SETUP Place 4 Drone Sample counters beside play. Each facedown Ultron drone you defeat adds 1.			OBJECTIVE Collect 4 Drone Sample counters before defeating Ultron.	Flag: DRONE SAMPLE
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 04		MIND OVER METAL		
Iron Man		Rhino / Rino	The Doomsday Chair / La Silla del Juicio Final	STANDARD
SETUP Set one Doomsday Chair side scheme and M.O.D.O.K. aside. Reveal the side scheme after setup; when it is defeated, reveal M.O.D.O.K.			OBJECTIVE Defeat M.O.D.O.K. before Rhino.	Flag: M.O.D.O.K. PROFILED
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 05		THE VIBRANIUM TRAIL		
Black Panther / Pantera Negra		Klaw	Legions of Hydra / Legiones de Hydra	STANDARD
SETUP Set Madame Hydra aside. After setup, reveal Legions of Hydra; when the first such side scheme leaves play, reveal Madame Hydra.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Madame Hydra before Klaw.	Flag: HYDRA LEDGER
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
INTERLUDE I — CHOOSE ONE				
HYDRA LEAD: Issue 8 remove 2 threat from initial Legions (min 1); Issue 10 M.O.D.O.K. gets Tough. • M.O.D.O.K. LEAD: Issue 10 deal 2 extra damage to M.O.D.O.K.; Issue 8 add 2 threat to initial Legions.				
ACT I RECOVERY				
Reduce Network by 1 if you completed 3+ objectives in Issues 1–5. Reduce it by 1 additional if you won 2 or fewer. Apply both if eligible, minimum 0.				

THE HIDDEN NETWORK

VETERAN • villain I → II • Standard + Expert encounter sets • custom bridge, not an official clear

ISSUE 06		ECHO CHAMBER		
Spider-Man / Spiderman		Klaw	Under Attack / Civiles en peligro	VETERAN
SETUP Set Under Attack aside; reveal after setup. If MASTERS BROKEN is not marked, add 1 threat to it.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Under Attack before Klaw advances to stage II. Flag: SONIC KEY	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 07		CITY OF DRONES		
Captain Marvel / Capitana Marvel		Ultron / Ultrón	Bomb Scare / Amenaza de bomba	VETERAN
SETUP Set Bomb Scare aside; reveal after setup. If BOMB DEFUSED is not marked, add 1 threat. Track 5 defeated drones.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Bomb Scare and collect 5 Drone Evacuation counters. Flag: EVACUATION COMPLETE	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 08		HARD CASE		
She-Hulk / Hulka		Rhino / Rino	Legions of Hydra / Legiones de Hydra	VETERAN
SETUP If HYDRA LEDGER is marked, set Madame Hydra aside before normal setup. After setup reveal Legions; if she was not set aside, resolve its printed When Revealed normally. If set aside, reveal her when first Legions leaves play. Apply Act I lead.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Madame Hydra and end with no Legions side scheme in play. Flag: RHINO CONFESSION	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 09		COUNTERFREQUENCY		
Iron Man		Klaw	Masters of Evil / Señores del Mal	VETERAN
SETUP Set Masters side scheme aside; reveal after setup. When defeated, reveal a named Master; if MASTERS BROKEN is unmarked, give it Tough. On Klaw II, if fewer than 2 different named Masters were defeated, reveal a different one.			OBJECTIVE Defeat 2 different named Masters before Klaw. Flag: FIREWALL STABLE	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 10		THE VIBRANIUM PROTOCOL		
Black Panther / Pantera Negra		Ultron / Ultrón	The Doomsday Chair / La Silla del Juicio Final	VETERAN
SETUP Set one Doomsday Chair side scheme + M.O.D.O.K. aside; reveal scheme after setup, then M.O.D.O.K. when it is defeated. If not PROFILED, look at top encounter card: reveal it only if Biomechanical Upgrades. DRONE SAMPLE deals 2 damage. Apply Act I lead.			OBJECTIVE Defeat M.O.D.O.K. and finish with no Doomsday Chair side scheme. Flag: VIBRANIUM SECURED	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
INTERLUDE II — CHOOSE ONE				
SHIELD THE CITY: Issue 14 remove 2 threat from main after setup; Issue 15 deal 1 extra facedown encounter card. • STRIKE THE CORE: Issue 14 deal 1 extra facedown encounter card; Issue 15 ignore highest Network Adaptation through round 1.				
ACT II RECOVERY				
Reduce Network by 1 if you completed 3+ objectives in Issues 6–10. Reduce it by 1 additional if you won 2 or fewer. Apply both if eligible, minimum 0.				

EXTINCTION DIRECTIVE

EXPERT • villain II → III • Standard + Expert encounter sets

FINAL PREPARATION

Before Issue 15, gain 1 point for each marked flag: WITNESS PROTECTED, EMBASSY SECURED, SKYLINE HELD, CITY SAVED. In Issue 15 after setup, spend each point to remove 1 threat from a scheme, deal 1 damage to a minion, or heal 1 damage from Iron Man. Options may repeat.

ISSUE 11		HOSTILE WITNESS	
She-Hulk / Hulka	Klaw	The Doomsday Chair / La Silla del Juicio Final	EXPERT
SETUP Set M.O.D.O.K. aside before normal setup. The first time Defense Network leaves play, reveal M.O.D.O.K. and engage him. If SONIC KEY is not marked, give him Tough.		OBJECTIVE Defeat M.O.D.O.K. before Klaw advances to stage III. Flag: WITNESS PROTECTED	

☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____

ISSUE 12		SIEGE PROTOCOL	
Black Panther / Pantera Negra	Rhino / Rino	Bomb Scare / Amenaza de bomba	EXPERT
SETUP Set Bomb Scare aside; reveal after setup. If RHINO CONFESSION is not marked, give Rhino Tough.		OBJECTIVE Defeat Bomb Scare before the end of round 2. Flag: EMBASSY SECURED	

☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____

ISSUE 13		TERMINAL VELOCITY	
Captain Marvel / Capitana Marvel	Rhino / Rino	Under Attack / Civiles en peligro	EXPERT
SETUP Set Under Attack aside; reveal after setup. If EVACUATION COMPLETE is not marked, add 2 threat to the main scheme.		OBJECTIVE Win while the main scheme has 2 or less threat. Flag: SKYLINE HELD	

☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____

Network Adaptations

NET	ADAPTATION	EFFECT
2	Early Warning	+1 threat on main after setup.
4	Reinforced Chassis	Villain gets Tough after setup.
6	Prepared Ambush	After mulligan, deal yourself 1 facedown encounter card.
8	Predictive Model	First villain activation gets +1 ATK or +1 SCH.
10	Recursive Backup	After villain advances, give Tough if it has none.

THE LAST LINE

ISSUE 14		THE LAST NEIGHBORHOOD		
Spider-Man / Spiderman		Ultron / Ultrón	Masters of Evil / Señores del Mal	EXPERT
SETUP Set Masters side scheme aside; reveal after setup and resolve its printed When Revealed normally. That Master is the target. If FIREWALL STABLE is unmarked, deal 1 facedown encounter card. Apply Act II assault. Track 5 defeated drones.			OBJECTIVE Defeat the side-scheme Master and collect 5 Drone Rescue counters. Flag: CITY SAVED	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				
ISSUE 15		THE ULTRON DIRECTIVE		
Iron Man		Ultron / Ultrón	Legions of Hydra / Legiones de Hydra	EXPERT
SETUP If VIBRANIUM SECURED is marked, set Madame Hydra aside before normal setup. After setup reveal Legions; if she was not set aside, resolve printed When Revealed normally. If set aside, reveal her when first Legions leaves play. Apply Act II assault + Final Preparation. At 15+ Intel, Endgame Protocol is extra.			OBJECTIVE Defeat Ultron with no side scheme in play and no minion engaged with you. Flag: CLEAN SHUTDOWN	
☐ Win ☐ Objective ☐ Mastery ☐ Scar added Intel after: ____ Network after: ____				

Campaign Ending

RESULT	ENDING
Win + Network 0–3 + 4+ Masteries	AVENGERS ASSEMBLE
Win + Network 4–6	MACHINE BROKEN
Win + Network 7+	PYRRHIC SHUTDOWN
IF YOU LOSE ISSUE 15 GHOST IN THE GRID.	
SECRET EPILOGUE — THE INITIATIVE Mark THE INITIATIVE only if all five heroes earned Mastery, you finish with 15+ Intel, and CLEAN SHUTDOWN is marked.	

FIELD ASSETS & MASTERIES

Field Assets are out-of-play campaign references. They are not upgrades/supports and cannot be targeted by encounter effects.

INTEL	ASSET	ONCE-PER-GAME EFFECT
3	Emergency Reserve	Reduce the cost of any card by 1.
3	Field Medic	Heal 2 damage from your identity.
6	S.H.I.E.L.D. Recon	Before encounter cards are dealt, look at the top 2 encounter cards; return them in either order.
6	Damage Control	After you defeat a side scheme, remove 2 threat from the main scheme.
9	Countermeasure Suite	After a boost card flips, blank 1 printed boost icon for that activation; not boost-star text.
9	Reactive Reflex	After your hero defends against an attack, ready your hero.
12	Stark-Wakanda Interface	Reduce an upgrade or support cost by 2, minimum 0.
12	Avengers Emergency Channel	After a basic ATK or THW, ready that hero and deal 1 damage to it.
15	Endgame Protocol	Issue 15 only. Interrupt: when a treachery is revealed, cancel its When Revealed effects; not Surge.
ASSET LIMIT		
Normally equip 1 unlocked Asset. At Network 6+, equip 2. Endgame Protocol does not count against this limit in Issue 15 if you have 15+ Intel.		

Hero Masteries

HERO	SIGNATURE	MASTERY
Spider-Man	Backflip / Voltereta hacia atrás	Prevent 4+ damage from one attack using Backflip.
Captain Marvel	Energy Channel / Canalizar energía	Deal the full 10 damage with Energy Channel.
She-Hulk	Gamma Slam / Apisonadora gamma	Deal 10+ damage with one Gamma Slam.
Iron Man	Supersonic Punch / Puñetazo supersónico	Deal 8 with Supersonic Punch while Aerial and controlling 5+ TECH upgrades.
Black Panther	Wakanda Forever! / ¡Wakanda por siempre!	Resolve all 4 different Black Panther upgrade Specials from the same Wakanda Forever! event.

MIRROR PROTOCOL

20 rematches. Reset Scars, Intel, Network, flags, special campaign setup, and Field Assets. Keep the listed modular set.

WHY 20?

Act I story games were official Standard → replay on Expert. Act III story games were official Expert → replay on Standard. Act II used Veteran, a custom bridge → replay each of those five pairings once on official Standard and once on official Expert. Story 15 + Mirror 20 = 35 total games.

HERO	VILLAIN	MODULAR	MODE	CLEAR
Spider-Man	Rhino	Bomb Scare	Expert	☐
Spider-Man	Klaw	Under Attack	Standard	☐
Spider-Man	Klaw	Under Attack	Expert	☐
Spider-Man	Ultron	Masters of Evil	Standard	☐
Captain Marvel	Klaw	Masters of Evil	Expert	☐
Captain Marvel	Ultron	Bomb Scare	Standard	☐
Captain Marvel	Ultron	Bomb Scare	Expert	☐
Captain Marvel	Rhino	Under Attack	Standard	☐
She-Hulk	Ultron	Under Attack	Expert	☐
She-Hulk	Rhino	Legions of Hydra	Standard	☐
She-Hulk	Rhino	Legions of Hydra	Expert	☐
She-Hulk	Klaw	The Doomsday Chair	Standard	☐
Iron Man	Rhino	The Doomsday Chair	Expert	☐
Iron Man	Klaw	Masters of Evil	Standard	☐
Iron Man	Klaw	Masters of Evil	Expert	☐
Iron Man	Ultron	Legions of Hydra	Standard	☐
Black Panther	Klaw	Legions of Hydra	Expert	☐
Black Panther	Ultron	The Doomsday Chair	Standard	☐
Black Panther	Ultron	The Doomsday Chair	Expert	☐
Black Panther	Rhino	Bomb Scare	Standard	☐

FIRST MIRROR GAME FOR EACH HERO

Use that hero’s fourth, previously unused aspect. After that, build freely.

PERFECT CORE

All 30 official Standard/Expert matchup boxes checked + all five heroes used all four aspects + all five Mastery stars earned. The Veteran story games are five additional bridge games, so the full journey is 35 games.